

FAQs

Sound problem with games

Q I have a P-III 1 GHz, 128 MB RAM and a KOB 815etfsx Mercury motherboard. I use Windows 98 as well as Windows XP. My problem is that whenever I play 3D games, sound becomes scratchy and later it just stops sounding right.

I have to restart my PC to rectify this. Is there a solution?

Harpreet Singh

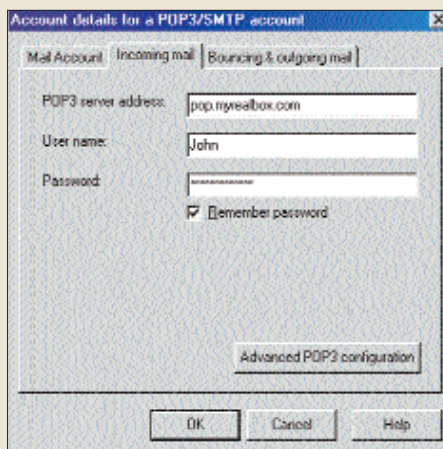
A Since you haven't mentioned which 3D games you run, we assume the problem occurs in all of them. Scratchy sound is usually a result of outdated or corrupt sound drivers. Update them to the latest available version. You'll need to refer to your manual to figure out the codec you've installed, in case you're using the onboard sound. You could also download and install DirectX 9.0b from Microsoft's Web site (www.microsoft.com/directx).

Configuring MailWasher 2.0

Q I have a problem related to MailWasher 2.0.40 beta. During the installation process, it gave me a message stating that I should give the address of the SMTP and POP server. How do I do that?

Pratyesh Somani

A It is a must to enter the addresses for the incoming (POP) and outgoing (SMTP) mail servers, else



Configuring MailWasher 2.0

MailWasher won't filter out the spam messages. Obtain them from your e-mail client settings. In the case of Outlook Express, go to **Tools > Accounts**. Here, select the account name, click Properties and go to the Servers tab to get the above-mentioned addresses.

Playing trailer videos

Q I have a Pentium 4 with 128 MB RAM and a 32 MB S3 Savage4 graphics card, running Windows Me and Windows XP Professional. The trailers of games and films on Digit CDs do not play on either Windows ME and Windows XP.

Also, I am unable to play games such as Quake III ever since I installed DirectX 9 drivers on Windows Me.

Malkeet Singh

A Most of the trailers provided on the Digit CDs are in DivX format so as to reduce the file size while maintaining video quality. You need to install the DivX codec, which is on the Mindware Digit CD, to play these files.



The Divx video encoder

Download the latest drivers available for Savage4 from www.s3graphics.com for Windows Me. If this does not fix it, revert to the older version of DirectX using System Restore. Go to **Start > Programs > Accessories > System Restore**. Select a restore point prior to installing DirectX 9 from the list. This restores your system to the previous DirectX configuration.

RPC error

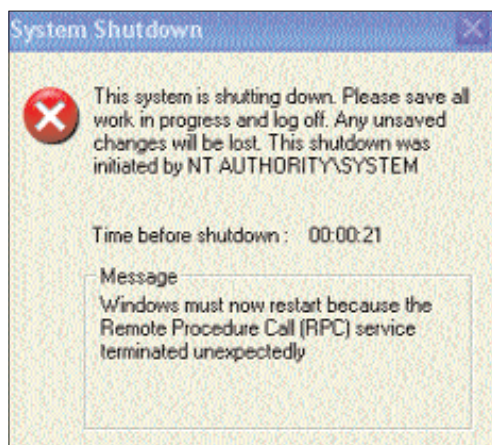
Q I use Windows XP Professional. While working, I get a Remote Procedure Call (RPC) error and my PC starts a shutdown procedure by showing a countdown of 1 minute, after which it actually restarts! This happens quite often. Help needed, sincerely!

Kalpesh Gajjar

A Yikes! It's the win32.Blaster worm that's infected your system. Here's how you manually remove this worm from your system. Press **[Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Del]** to bring up the Task Manager and remove any currently running instance of msblast.exe.

Enable the Internet Connection Firewall in Windows XP. Go to **Control Panel > Network Connections**,

right-click your Internet connection and select Properties. In the Advanced tab, under Internet Connection Firewall,



This is the error message that MSBlaster brings up

check 'Protect my computer and network by limiting or preventing access to this computer from the Internet' to enable the firewall. Now, apply the security patch available for this worm at the Microsoft Web site.

A detailed description about the worm, its solution and update is available at <http://support.microsoft.com/default.aspx?scid=/directory/worldwide/ja/kb/blast/t009/7/02.asp>.



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E-mail us your computing problems, and we may

answer them here! Since we get more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!